ANSWER KEY

QP CODE:25901452

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

Fourth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG4DSCPOL201 - THEMES IN INDIAN POLITICS

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

PART A

1. Charvaka/Lokayata

2. Panchayati Raj/Three-Tier System

3. 1956

4. Article 243D (for Panchayats) and Article 243T (for Municipalities)

5. Kaka Kalelkar Commission (1953)

6. Dandi March

7. Telugu Desam Party

8. Article 352

9. Competitive Federalism

10. Nawab Khwaja Salimullah (others include Aga Khan, Nawab Mohsin-ul-Mulk & Nawab Viqar-ul-Mulk)

PART B

11. Reservation for SCs and STs is mandated under Articles 330 and 332—ensures political representation—promotes social justice and equality in legislatures.

12.Fair EWS reservation requires transparent income and asset criteria—systematic data-robust verification mechanisms—periodic review – mechanisms for preventing misuse and ensure genuine beneficiaries.

13. Secularism enshrined in Preamble -defines India as a secular nation- Articles 25-28—guarantees freedom of religion—mandates equal treatment of all faiths by the state.

14. Cooperative federalism emphasizes collaboration between Union and States—NITI Aayog nurtures shared policy-making—strengthens inclusive development and balanced governance.

15. Subaltern perspective highlights marginalized voices—critiques elite-centric nationalism—emphasizes grassroots struggles in shaping Indian identity.

16. Supporters of “India” stressed historical continuity—legal and constitutional orientation-global recognition of the name—unity and inclusiveness across diverse communities.

17. Coalition politics arises from multi-party democracy—requires consensus-building—often leads to compromise governance but reflects pluralism.

18. Religious nationalism links faith with political identity—mobilizes communities around cultural-religious symbols—shapes socio-political discourse in India.

19. L.M. Singhvi Committee- emphasized grassroots democracy—recommended constitutional recognition of Panchayati Raj—strengthened decentralization and local governance.

20. Territorial perspective defines India through geography and boundaries—reinforced unity during nationalist movement—significance lay in collective identity across diverse regions.

PART C

21.Revolt of 1857-exposed deep discontent against colonial rule—though suppressed, it marked the first large-scale resistance—created a sense of unity across regions and classes, laying groundwork for later nationalist movements.

22. Regional parties amplify local voices—strengthen representation of diverse communities—shape coalition governments and policies, ensuring inclusivity but sometimes fragmenting national consensus.

23.Indian secularism emphasizes principled distance—state engages with religions contextually—balances freedom of faith with social reform, unlike strict western separation-reflecting pluralism and diversity.

24. During Emergency, federal structure tilted towards central dominance—state powers curtailed—President and Union government exercised overriding authority-increasing role for parliament- weakening autonomy but highlighting resilience of constitutional safeguards post-crisis.